

- ▶ **Proximity sensor:** This sensor can detect how close other objects – such as your face or a table – are to the phone. This is so the phone can know when you're making a phone call or when you've placed the device on a table. It can also know when it's in a pocket and thus not respond to button taps.
- ▶ **FM radio tuner:** All Windows Phones ship with an FM radio tuner, providing free access to FM radio and, via bundled software, the ability to mark particular stations as favourites. These specs are what Microsoft calls its "Chassis-1" specs. Presumably, over time, there'll be further updates to the requirements.

What's not on every Windows Phone

If you're an eagle-eyed technology follower, or are simply performing due diligence for your next two-year commitment, you may have noticed that the Windows Phone hardware requirement list doesn't include some hardware features that you believe are important or even necessary in a modern smartphone. In some cases, these omissions are nothing to worry about. Hardware makers are free to exceed Microsoft's requirements and bundle additional features with their phones. In other cases, however, the lack of certain features is a bit more troubling, because the underlying platform simply doesn't support this hardware. Here are some features that Microsoft – good, bad or indifferently – doesn't explicitly require its phone makers to include with a Windows Phone. When picking a Windows Phone, it's a good idea to understand which of these features are valuable to you and choose a device according to its included features.

- ▶ **Wi-Fi:** Despite its absence from the hardware requirement list, you can expect virtually every Windows Phone to include 802.11g (Wi-Fi G) or 802.11n (Wi-Fi N) wireless networking capabilities.
- ▶ **Bluetooth:** There's a similar issue with Bluetooth, a separate wireless networking standard that is most often used to connect portable devices with in-ear headsets, keyboards, in-car navigation systems and other hardware.
- ▶ **Removable storage:** Most non-iPhone smartphones (and virtually all popular Android-based phones) ship with some kind of memory card slot